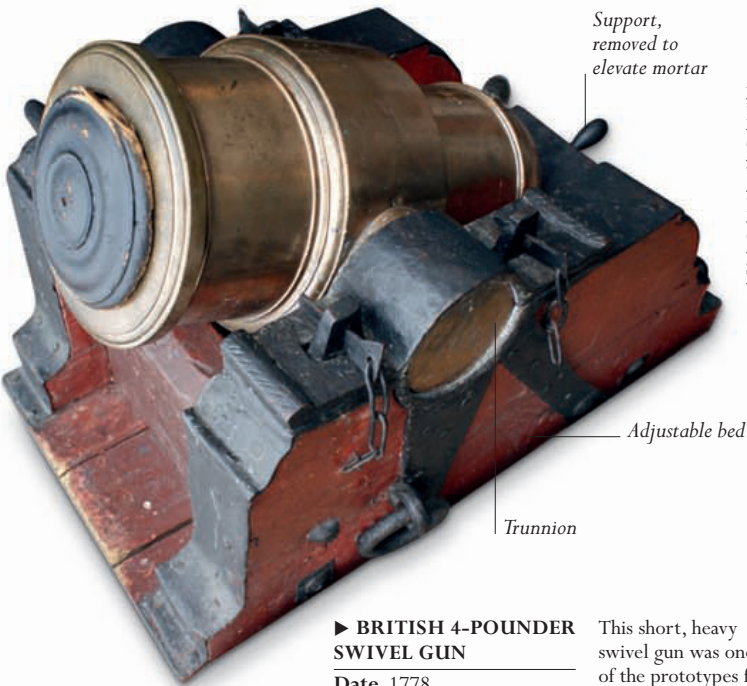


CARRONADES AND OTHER NAVAL GUNS

Carronades – a type of smoothbore cast-iron cannon – were an important addition to naval firepower in the late 18th and early 19th century, supplementing light weapons such as multi-shot guns, swivel guns, rockets, and mortars. Quickly adopted by the British, US, Russian, and French navies, carronades – so-called because they were manufactured by the Carron Ironworks in Falkirk, Scotland – were powerful, short-barrelled guns that were relatively lightweight and could be operated by a small crew, but were devastating in close-range engagements. Moreover, while heavy guns such as 32-pounders had to be carried near the waterline so as not to destabilize a ship, carronades were light enough to be mounted on the upper deck.



Support, removed to elevate mortar

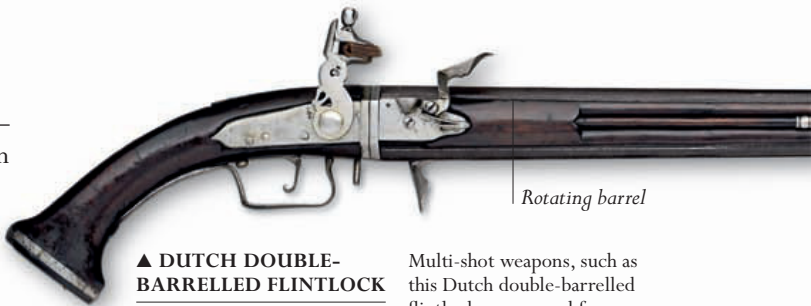
Adjustable bed

Trunnion

◀ **SWEDISH 20-POUNDER MORTAR**

Date	1735
Origin	Sweden
Weight	4.1 tonnes (4.5 tons)
Length	1.5m (5ft)
Calibre	13in
Shot	9kg (20lb)

The Swedish navy of the mid-18th century equipped smaller vessels (bomb ketches) with trunnioned mortars, which were adjustable to fire at an elevated angle for improved range. This bronze mortar was mounted towards the bow and generally used to bombard fortifications on land.



Rotating barrel

▲ **DUTCH DOUBLE-BARRELLED FLINTLOCK**

Date	17th century
Origin	Netherlands
Weight	1.2kg (2½lb)
Barrel	50.3cm (19¾in)
Calibre	36-bore

Multi-shot weapons, such as this Dutch double-barrelled flintlock, were used for boarding actions, due to the difficulty of reloading single-shot weapons at close quarters or on an often-pitching deck.

▶ **BRITISH 4-POUNDER SWIVEL GUN**

Date	1778
Origin	Scotland
Length	31.8cm (12½in)
Calibre	8.4cm
Shell	1.8kg (4lb)

This short, heavy swivel gun was one of the prototypes for the carronade made by the Carron Ironworks. Its trunnions are fitted with pivots and the cascabel connected to a long, curved handle for moving the gun.

▶ **BRITISH 13IN MORTAR**

Date	1726
Origin	England
Weight	4.1 tonnes (4.5 tons)
Length	1.6m (5½ft)
Calibre	13in

The reinforce ring of this sea service mortar shows the royal arms of the British king, George II. The mortar may have been made for HMS *Thunder*, which saw action at the Siege of Gibraltar in 1727.



Carrying handles

Replacement bed, 2.64m (8½ft) long



Reinforce ring

Pivots at trunnion

Trunnion inscription reads "Carron 1778" with "180" above